

Wândyr Turn Clock

The Turn Clock counts the passage of time in the game. It is a tool for the Guide to manage the pace of the game and to help players feel more aware of the passage of in-game time and the weight of their actions. This uses the OSR time scale where one "turn" is about ten minutes of in-game time. So typical actions each take one "turn", such as searching a room, picking a lock, checking for traps or secret doors, looting a body, etc.

Most combats take a few rounds and are resolved in a single turn, and so the Turn Clock is not used during combat, chases, tense negotiations, or other action-packed encounters. Only use the Turn Clock when the potential for pacing issues exist, and players might otherwise spend a lot of time in discussions or side actions.

Setting Up the Turn Clock

Put a bowl (ideally glass or metal) and six normal dice in the middle of the table. The bowl is the "Turn Clock" and the dice are used to count turns.

Marking Time

Whenever the players spend a Turn doing something, toss a die into the Turn Clock. For example, if they stop to check for traps on a door, pick a lock, look for a secret door, search a room, cast a spell, count the gold found in a pouch, or loot a body, then toss a die into the Turn Clock.

If the players take a few minutes of real-world time to have a long conversation about what to do next and seem to be stuck, toss a die into the Turn Clock to remind them that time is passing in the game. If they are loitering, then toss a die into the Turn Clock to remind them that they need to take action.

If one player is taking a Turn to do something time-consuming, other players may want to take actions of their own, which does not add extra dice. However, for any player action, always consider whether this would be better as a Side Action (see below).

Reckless Actions

During exploration, investigation, and other slow-paced parts of the game, whenever a player commits to a Reckless action, roll the Turn Clock to check for a Complication. If there are no dice in the turn clock then roll one die and put it into the Turn Clock. What constitutes a Reckless action can vary based on the situation, but it is generally reckless to draw attention to

the group when there may be foes about (e.g. rival thieves in a city, monsters in a dungeon, goblins prowling the hills, etc).

Complications

When rolling the Turn Clock, a Complication arises when any dice show 1. Multiple 1's indicate a more *complicated complication*.

Clearing the Turn Clock

Whenever you add the sixth die to the Turn Clock, immediately dump out the bowl to roll the dice to check for a Complication. The Turn Clock can never have more than six dice, so not return the dice to the Turn Clock.

The Guide may also find it helpful to tell the players than an hour of in-game time has passed.

Side Actions

A Side Action is a tangential action that is interesting to a single player, but not the entire group. Too many Side Actions can cause player to become bored or lose focus and turn to their screens. For example, one player might want to experiment with a magic item they found, but that takes time and might be boring for some players.

When a player mentions a Side Action during the game, any player can suggest they save it to retcon later. The player is responsible for bringing up the saved Side Action later, ideally as in-between game sessions, over email, etc. Until they do so, the action hasn't yet occurred.

If the group discovers a saved Side Action is actually immediately relevant to the current game play, then resume the action and add a die to the Turn Clock.

Effects of the Turn Clock

The Turn Clock can help track consumption of resources such as light sources.

- Low-quality torch: 5-10 minutes (1 Turn) @20' radius
- High-quality torch: 1 hour (6 Turns) @40' radius
- Oil lantern: 5 hours (30 Turns) @60' radius
- Active Spells: last for "the current encounter". They normally end whenever adding a die to the Turn Clock, unless the dice are rolled and result in a new encounter (Complication).